JONATHAN SEIDMAN

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Experienced technical writer and author. My background spans decades in software, primarily as a developer, before transitioning into technical writing. This experience gives me the technical depth to understand and validate technical content, write clear, usable content for different audiences, write and test example code, and manage the documentation publishing toolchain. In addition to creating content, I've owned the information architecture, style, and editorial standards for sites that document rapidly evolving systems, and incorporated those standards into AI-assisted tooling that drafts and reviews documentation and ensures it stays up to date with product changes.

Co-author of *Hadoop Application Architectures* and *Foundations for Architecting Data Solutions (O'Reilly Media)* and technical editor and reviewer for several books on data processing and engineering. Previously co-founder and organizer of the Chicago Hadoop and Chicago Big Data user groups.

SKILLS

Git, GitHub, Markdown, MDX, CI/CD, Nextra, Docusaurus, REST APIs, AWS, Azure, Java, Python, familiarity with JavaScript/TypeScript, Jira, Claude Code, Snagit, Grammarly

Areas of Expertise

Technical Writing and Editing | Developer and API Documentation | Documentation as Code | Information Architecture | AI-Assisted Documentation Tooling | Enterprise Data Systems | Observability Systems | Cross-Functional Team Leadership

Professional Experience

GREPR, San Francisco, CA **2025-2026**

Technical Writer

Sole owner of the documentation site at an observability startup: information architecture, content strategy, writing, editing, and the site-generation framework. Implemented AI-assisted documentation tooling using Claude Code skills to scale content creation for a rapidly evolving product.

Documentation Redesign and Strategy

- Led a redesign and reorganization of the documentation site and homepage, including:
  - A redesign of the homepage to provide a concise product overview and topic trails to learn more.
  - A restructured table of contents to direct users to relevant content and improve SEO by adding top-level sections, rewriting titles, labels, and headings to be descriptive and intent-driven, and adding metadata descriptions.
  - A reorganization of complex, single-page documentation into focused overview, reference, and example pages, plus new content to fill gaps, using Claude Code to identify those gaps and correct invalid content.
- Created and applied style, formatting, and content guidelines for all contributors and incorporated them into review tooling to ensure all documentation was checked against these guidelines.
- Introduced Nextra features to improve usability, including callouts, shared components, and tabbed content. Built a custom Nextra plugin that automatically keeps link text consistent when linked pages change.

AI-Assisted Tooling (Claude Code)

- Implemented, maintained, and iteratively improved workflows using Claude Code skills to generate draft documentation and release notes, validate new and existing content, and detect documentation drift:
  - A release notes skill to detect user-facing changes in code commits, draft notes, and update navigation.
  - A documentation generation skill to create high-quality first drafts from existing code or new commits.
  - A review skill to check documentation for grammar, technical accuracy, links, and style compliance.
  - A proof-of-concept tool to match customer questions in Slack to existing docs, identifying missing content or pages that need improvement.

Cross-Functional Collaboration

- Collaborated with marketing on blog posts and customer communications.
- Reviewed and edited engineer-submitted docs and API updates; contributed to front-end text.
- Shipped codebase fixes: bugs, broken links, typos, and text usability improvements.

DATABRICKS, San Francisco, CA **2020-2025**
Senior Technical Writer

Owned documentation for Databricks' data engineering tools and led documentation efforts for three major platform launches, while driving process improvements, mentoring, and cross-team education.

Product Documentation and Launch Ownership

- Owned documentation for the launch of Delta Live Tables (now Lakeflow Pipelines), Databricks' ETL framework, and maintained documentation for Databricks Jobs (now Lakeflow Jobs) as the product rapidly grew.
- Wrote launch documentation for Databricks Apps, a framework that enables developers to deploy applications on the platform, working closely with engineering and product teams to ensure technical accuracy.
- Reorganized and updated documentation content with stakeholder input, improving searchability and usability, and driving 20%+ increases in page views.

Process and Cross-Team Leadership

- Took ownership of release notes for a core component of the Databricks stack, improving quality by educating writers, engineers, and product managers on how to write usable, consistent release notes through presentations, reviews, and one-on-ones.
- Partnered with release management and engineering to ensure behavioral and breaking changes were communicated to users in advance and reflected in release notes at release time, resolving a longstanding source of customer frustration.
- Worked closely with engineers, product managers, and UI developers to improve the quality of customer-facing content, including API messages, UI text, and tooltips.

Mentoring and Team Development

- Mentored new technical writers, providing style-guide training, content review and feedback, and task delegation and supervision. Ran presentations and 1:1 sessions to raise the bar for the documentation team's technical clarity and accuracy.

CLOUDERA, Palo Alto, CA **2012-2020**
Software Engineer | 2017-2020

Worked on a cross-functional team of developers to enable Cloudera's products to run on public clouds. This work included developing and enhancing Java and Python applications for deployment on Amazon Web Services and Microsoft Azure:

- Architected and implemented a system to securely and reliably transport logs from customer environments to the internal environment, reducing time to diagnose issues and resulting in less customer frustration.
- Worked with stakeholders across Cloudera teams to design a solution to automate partner certifications. Built a prototype web application based on Spring Boot.
- Created documentation and samples to onboard new developers and provide guidance on integrating with the team's components to members of other teams.

Senior Solutions Architect, Partner Engineering | 2014-2017
Solutions Architect, Partner Engineering | 2012-2014

Worked with partners, customers, and Cloudera teams to design, validate, and certify the integration of partner solutions with Cloudera's software stack. Also partnered with the marketing team to prepare collateral for white papers and webinars that highlighted the features and benefits of integrations, leading to more integrations, greater adoption of Cloudera's products, and higher revenue for Cloudera and partners.

ORBITZ WORLDWIDE, Chicago, IL **2009-2012**
Lead Engineer, Business Intelligence / Big Data Team | 2011-2012

Worked on the team managing Hadoop clusters at Orbitz. Evangelized and facilitated user access to Hadoop for data analysis, providing developers and analysts with access to data analysis that wasn't feasible with existing data management tools.

Lead Engineer, Intelligent Marketplace and Machine Learning Teams | 2009-2011

Implemented a big data infrastructure using Hadoop and Hive to support the machine learning team's data storage and analysis requirements, and used it to develop applications and conduct analyses for the team's work.